



#EVERYCHILD 2030: MAKING THE SDGS DELIVER FOR ALL CHILDREN

An update on SDG Implementation and Monitoring from the Public Partnerships Division – October 2017

Dear Colleagues,

Welcome to the 26th issue of *#EVERYCHILD 2030: Making the SDGs Deliver for All Children*. The following newsletter is a special feature on SDG processes from a child focused lens at the High Level Political Forum in July and the UN General Assembly in September.

The High Level Political Forum (HLPF) is the main platform for stocktaking on SDG implementation efforts and monitoring progress, including what countries are doing in this space. Taking place annually in July, countries voluntarily submit SDG national reviews to the HLPF. As 2017 was the second year of the HLPF's Voluntary National Reviews (VNRs) process, we are pleased to report a significant strengthening of references to children in the 2017 reports, which are also better grounded in data and action-oriented policies. 43 Member States submitted a VNR, almost double from 2016 and approximately a third of the UN Membership. UNICEF conducted an internal analysis of the reports from a child rights perspective which reports both on the strides made as well as potential areas for improvement. The analysis report furthermore gives insight into the national localization processes and highlights key themes pertaining to children and Agenda 2030. UNICEF also co-organized two HLPF side events underscoring the importance of engaging children and youth in SDG processes of which summaries are included in this edition.

Already looking towards 2018, 48 Member States have volunteered to report on the SDGs, giving UNICEF and partners more time to advocate for children's issues in SDG planning, budgeting and monitoring. The Agenda 2030 team is working to update our set of advocacy materials for the 2018 theme, *Transformation towards sustainable and resilient societies*.

The General Assembly this year also demonstrated a continued commitment by Member States to achieve Agenda 2030. A rapid analysis of Heads of State who referenced children, adolescents and youth in the context of the SDGs is included in the below articles as well as summaries on key side events co-hosted by UNICEF and partners.

Leading up to COP23, we are also pleased to announce an exciting initiative for child and youth awareness and engagement, which is the launch of the *Climate! Comic! Contest!* asking children to learn about their environment and creatively develop a planet-saving superhero. The top superhero submissions will be voted on worldwide during COP23 in November to highlight the innovative ideas of young people in implementing the SDGs and the Paris Agreement.

We hope you enjoy these updates. The success of this newsletter hinges on the inputs and feedback from all offices, so please send reactions to us: [Mandeep O'Brien](#); [Shannon O'Shea](#); [Callie King-Guffey](#).

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SDGS ARE REVIEWED BY 43 MEMBER STATES AT HIGH-LEVEL POLITICAL FORUM (HLPF) WITH MAJOR STRIDES IN REFERENCES TO CHILDREN'S ISSUES AND INCLUSION

Forty-three Governments, nearly one quarter of the UN Membership, submitted a voluntary national review at this year's [High-Level Political Forum \(HLPF\)](#). The theme of the 2017 HLPF, taking place in New York from 10 July–19 July, was *Eradicating Poverty and Promoting Prosperity in a Changing World*.

UNICEF and partners provided assistance to country offices and national committees that were operating in countries producing VNRs. Offices advocated for and assisted with the inclusion of children in consultative processes and encouraged child issues to be reflected in the review of goal areas. In lead up to the VNR process, Agenda 2030 produced the following guidance materials:



Guidance Materials on SDG Follow-Up and Review Provided to COs and NatComs

- [Key Asks and Principles for National Reviews](#)
- A set of short issue briefs on the topics of: [Investing in Children](#); [Collection of disaggregated data on the situation of children](#); and [Child and Adolescent Participation](#).
- Sector specific issue briefs for sharing with partners: [Goal 1: No Poverty](#); [Goal 2: Zero Hunger](#); [Goal 3: Health and Well-Being](#); [Goal 5: Gender Equality](#); and [Goal 14: Life Below Water](#).

Following the HLPF, this internal [UNICEF Analysis Report](#) highlights the strengths and weaknesses of the VNRs from a child rights perspective. The report also explains the means in which countries have localized the SDGs.

Read the Group of Friends of Children's [joint statement read during the HLPF](#) by Luxembourg (GOF Co-Chair), on behalf of 53 out of the 55 GOF Members, the most signatories of a GOF statement to date.

Prior to the HLPF, the GoF met in June to discuss the inclusion of children's issues and voices in SDG Follow-Up and Review processes. Three students presented to the group and discussed their experiences learning about and taking action on the issues in the SDGs. The students encouraged the Member States to include children in SDG implementation and monitoring efforts as agents of change.

A few [Case Studies, distilling best practices and lessons learned from Country Offices and National Committees](#), has also been produced and is available on the [Agenda 2030 SharePoint page](#) to assist countries in engaging with governments and partners in the lead up to national reviews.

48 MEMBER STATES HAVE VOLUNTEERED FOR 2018

The 2017 analyses and iterative guidance documents will aim to support offices in the cohort of the 2018 VNR processes. **48 Member States have already volunteered to report next year**, 44 of which UNICEF has a presence, giving ample time for UNICEF and partners to begin advocacy. The [Key Asks and Principles](#) in addition to the issue briefs will be updated by the Agenda 2030 team with support of various sections and offices. While the HLPF does not occur until July, countries begin the consultative and drafting processes months in advance in order to submit the report by May

or June. The 2018 HLPF theme is *Transformation towards sustainable and resilient societies*. The SDGs under review in 2018 will be SDG 6 (Water and Sanitation), SDG 7 (Energy), SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities), SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production) and SDG 15 (Life on Land). The 48 volunteers for 2018 are:

Albania	Andorra	Armenia	Australia	Bahamas	Bahrain
Benin	Bhutan	Cabo Verde	Canada	Colombia	Dominican Rep.
Ecuador	Egypt	Greece	Guinea	Hungary	Iceland
Ireland	Jamaica	Kiribati	Laos	Latvia	Lebanon
Lithuania	Mali	Malta	Mexico	Namibia	Niger
Paraguay	Poland	Qatar	Rep. of Congo	Romania	Saudi Arabia
Senegal	Singapore	Slovakia	Spain	Sri Lanka	Palestine
Sudan	Switzerland	Togo	UAE	Uruguay	Vietnam

For any questions on the HLPF VNR process and the guidance materials, please contact [Shannon O'Shea](#).

UNICEF HLPF SIDE EVENT FEATURES STUDENTS OF THE WORLD'S LARGEST LESSON ADDRESSING THE PRESIDENT OF THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY AND MEMBER STATES

Over 80 students from [Nord Anglia Education](#) schools in Asia, Europe, Middle East and North America presented their experience in learning about sustainable development and their recommendations for governments and partners to educate and engage children and youth in the SDGs. Addressing senior representatives including the (former) President of the UN General Assembly, H.E. Mr. Peter Thomson, and UNICEF Executive Director Mr. Lake, the students traveled from 15 countries to attend the HLPF side-event co-hosted by the governments of Bulgaria, Malaysia and Argentina together with UNICEF, Project Everyone and Nord Anglia Education.

During the 2016-17 school year, Nord Anglia students used the [World's Largest Lesson](#) to raise awareness of and take action towards Goals 2 and 3, which aim to end hunger and improve health and well-being. The student's methodology has been donated to the World's Largest Lesson for wider implementation.

In their presentation, Indira Patel, a student at Dover Court International School, Singapore, commented, "The Global Goals are like a jigsaw puzzle. The more pieces joined together, the more people working on it, the easier the puzzle becomes and the closer you are to achieving the picture."



Watch the highlight reel of NAE students addressing leaders about the WLL [here](#).

Andrew Fitzmaurice, CEO of Nord Anglia Education, said, "We believe in empowering our students to take action. This year, over 13,000 Nord Anglia students from our 44 schools around the world were actively involved in projects to support the realization of the SDGs, developing innovative solutions leading to meaningful impact in their local communities. We are very proud of our students and think their passion is an inspiration to us all to make a difference."



Anthony Lake, UNICEF's Executive Director, gave closing remarks to the students and audience stating, "As we, who are just a little older, listen to you -- as we learn from you -- we're inspired not only by your passion and dedication today, but by the responsible, creative and dedicated global citizens you're fast becoming."

UNICEF HLPF SIDE EVENT HIGHLIGHTS THE USE OF PERCEPTION DATA COLLECTED THROUGH U-REPORT AS A METRIC OF WELL-BEING AND SDG PROGRESS

UNICEF co-hosted an HLPF side event, entitled '*Perception Data as a Metric of Well-Being*', showcasing the results of several pilots that used quantitative and qualitative methodologies to collect perception data on the SDGs in order to assist decision-makers in SDG review activities. Co-sponsored by the governments of Guatemala and Zimbabwe, UNICEF, World Food Programme (WFP), SDG Action Campaign, and the Institute of Development Studies (IDS), the event focused on six of the seven goals (1, 2, 3, 5, 9, 14) under review during this year's HLPF and attracted about 100 participants.

In setting the context, Mandeep O'Brien, Associate Director, UNICEF Public Partnerships Division noted that when Member States agreed on the Agenda 2030 in 2015, they also acknowledged the need to cultivate the participation of a wide range of diverse actors and stakeholders in the implementation and monitoring of the SDGs. "There was a very strong emphasis on the importance of collection, analysis and use of disaggregated data, which is instrumental for influencing policy making, decision making, programming, service delivery, as well as influencing social norms and trying to reach those most left behind," she said.

Presenters shared results from pilot countries obtained using mobile tools like UNICEF's U-Report and WFP's mVAM, on-line surveys like My World 2030, and offline qualitative methods like IDS's Participatory Monitoring and Accountability Programme to inform SDG implementation and decision-making.



The side event contributed to the HLPF theme "*Eradicating Poverty and Promoting Prosperity in a Changing World*" by demonstrating that perception data improves the wellbeing of people around the world by providing information that supplements objective indicators and draws attention to important issues that are often missed or ignored.



Although 43 Member States volunteered to report on SDG progress at this year's HLPF, the pilot projects were only conducted in a select number of these countries. Some pilot countries, however, included the poll results in their VNR, such as Guatemala.

Read the full [ICON article here](#). A full report on the perception data pilot project is forthcoming and results will be made available on the [UNICEF Agenda 2030 SharePoint Page](#) when ready. To view the presentations used at the side event, see the link [here](#).

For any questions on the side-event or project, please contact [Shannon O'Shea](#) and [Moumié Maoulidi](#).

UNICEF INDONESIA LAUNCHES SDG BASELINE REPORT ON CHILDREN IN INDONESIA

Indonesia was one of the 43 countries to present a VNR to the HLPF on SDG plans and progress. To supplement the VNR, UNICEF Indonesia worked with the government (Ministry of Development Planning) to produce an [SDG Baseline Report on Children in Indonesia](#) (snapshot [here](#)). The report examines and visualizes priority child-related SDG indicators. “How children are faring,” the report explains, “in terms of their health and nutrition, their welfare and education, and the environment in which they grow up in – is a direct predictor of what Indonesia’s future will look like.” The baseline report will inform an online platform with an interactive dashboard to visualize the data and make it accessible to the public and policy makers at subnational level.

UNICEF Indonesia also used the Key Asks document provided by the Agenda 2030 team to guide a [2017 Action Plan](#) for SDG Roll-Out for Children in Indonesia. It is a working draft to bring all the different SDG related activities into one framework, to help build on synergies and identify areas for action. Some key areas are: (i) calculating the cost of inaction; (ii) mapping and analysis of the interlinkages between the SDGs and SDG related actions needed to achieve progress; and (iii) the inclusion of specific actions and targets for children into the national and subnational SDG action plans.

For the first time, a forecasting analysis was also carried out for children in Indonesia, developed by the Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU) for UNICEF Indonesia and resulting in the two publications [Megatrends to 2030](#) and [Scenarios to 2030](#). In sum, the reports look at how macro-economic trends in Indonesia will affect children in Indonesia in 2030. The trend analysis highlights the pathways these trends might take in the period to 2030, their drivers, and impact they will have for children in Indonesia in the period to 2030 – and presents them in three possible scenarios for children in Indonesia in 2030: a “best case scenario” of ‘what if Indonesia achieves the priority SDGs for children’, a “business as usual” case and a “worst case” scenario. The reports are expected to serve as a useful reference to inform our programming, dialogue with counterparts, and forthcoming generation of evidence.



UNICEF Indonesia co-hosted the [SDG Youth Forum in Jakarta](#) which resulted in young people recommending to the Government of Indonesia and the UN System the following key messages:

- 1) Help youth groups conduct ‘reality checks’ and policy reviews regarding the SDGs. A ‘reality check’ invites young people to provide qualitative support in the field for data-backed findings. These are then used to help the Government produce policy on SDG implementation.
- 2) Ramp up advocacy and allow youth to assist in formulating SDG reports.
- 3) Provide capacity-building for network members to ensure that the forum led to real action.

Given UNICEF Indonesia’s wealth of materials developed for SDG implementation and monitoring activities please see [the folder on the Agenda 2030 SharePoint page](#) dedicated to the sharing and use of these resources.

For any questions please contact [Charlotte Lie-Piang](#) in the Indonesia Country Office.

INNOCENTI LAUNCHES REPORT CARD ON CHILDREN AND SDGS IN RICH COUNTRIES

Stressing the universality of the SDGs, Innocenti launched [Building the Future: Children and the Sustainable Development Goals in Rich Countries](#), the 14th Report Card to date. The report measures child well-being in 41 countries against the SDGs. The Report Card shows that across most high income countries, 1 in 5 children live in poverty, combined with the widening gap in income inequality.

At the launch, Sarah Cook, Director of UNICEF Innocenti, remarked that “The report helps to put children firmly in the centre of achieving the sustainable development goals, achieving equity and sustainability for all children, leaving no child behind, recognizing that meeting the sustainable development goals requires a focus on every child, in order for us to achieve sustainability in the future, but also to improve their well-being today.” Read more about the launch in London [here](#).

CHILDREN AND THE SDGS IN 72nd UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY

The new President of the General Assembly, H.E. Mr. Miroslav Lajčák of Slovakia made his theme of the 72nd session clear in his opening and closing statements. The focus of his presidency will be “*Focusing on People: Striving for Peace and a Decent Life for All on a Sustainable Planet.*” Drawing attention to the need and opportunity to bring the UN closer to the people, he explicitly stated that “we need to hear more young voices in this Hall.”

A rapid analysis of Heads of State Statements and their references to children in the context of the SDGs is available [here](#). The analysis illustrates that while child protection and education were thematically addressed in a host of statements, children and youth were mostly referred to as either a vulnerable group or threat.

Evident in some of the major high level side events, however, UNICEF and child-focused agencies have made great strides in building government interest and dedication to children’s participation and engagement with the SDGs as agents of change. The child-focused agencies co-hosted an event titled “*A promise to children: Their rights and well-being in the SDGs*” which aimed to elevate the centrality of children in the implementation of the SDGs. Keynote speaker, Ana Helena Chacón Echeverría, Vice President of Costa Rica, emphasized the importance to keep children central when countries are in the process of nationalizing Agenda 2030 into their own plans. She also made explicit reference to the country’s implementation of the [World’s Largest Lesson](#), an initiative led by UNICEF and Project Everyone bringing the issues of the SDGs to children in schools.

AMONG OTHER EVENTS, UNICEF CO-HOSTED THE FOLLOWING:

GLOBAL GOALS DINNER

This year, the *Global Goals Awards* honored outstanding activists or campaign groups who have demonstrated a positive impact in people’s lives and who inspire others to accelerate progress towards the SDGs. Winners were chosen from finalists in each of the categories, and voted in by the SDG Advocates and Melinda Gates. The awards were announced during the UN General Assembly at a Global Goals Awards dinner on September 19th in New York. Meet [the 2017 winners here](#)!



HIGH-LEVEL SIDE EVENT ON CLIMATE CHANGE EDUCATION AND YOUTH

Co-hosted at UNICEF headquarters in partnership with the Government of Morocco (COP22 President), UNFCCC, the high level event highlighted that children and young people are often the most vulnerable and affected by climate change. One speaker in particular explained the importance of “education as a powerful tool to address climate change issues and the role of youth as agents of change.” The discussion included a young speaker from *Voices of Future Generations*, Jona David Cordonier-Gehring, an 11 year old award winning author and child ambassador for the SDGs. Jona pointed to the importance “to stand up not just for children today but for all future generations of children. See full [ICON story here](#).



HIGH-LEVEL SIDE EVENT ON 'CHILDREN'S PARTICIPATION AND THE 2030 AGENDA'



This high level side event was co-hosted by Chile, UNDP and UNICEF. Speakers included Justin Forsyth, UNICEF Deputy Director, Michelle Bachelet, President of Chile, Tarja Halonen, Former President of Finland, and Askadeline Milanes, child speaker from the NYC Mayor’s office of the Junior Ambassador Program. The event covered ways in which multiple countries, including Chile and Finland, are operationalizing the call for improving meaningful child participation in order to better and more sustainably deliver basic services and protect children. UNICEF gave the examples of using U-Report, an SMS polling tool, to enable the voices of children, including those in conflict, to inform service deliverers and policy makers in taking more targeted actions for girls and refugees in particular. Askadeline, a 12-year old Dominican-American spoke about her experience learning about the SDGs and her class’s inspiration to get involved. Her school in the Bronx decided to take action in the community and raise awareness about gender equality and the treatment girls face around the world. She poignantly stated, “In 2030 I will be 26 years old. But I don’t want to wait until then. We can start doing things now, so the future could be a better place for every living thing.” Read Askadeline’s [Voices of Youth blog based on her speech here](#).

BRINGING THE SDGS TO CHILDREN IN THE CLASSROOM AND CREATING ACTION FOR CHANGE'

An [SDG Media Zone interview](#) with Alison Bellwood, Director of World’s Largest Lesson, Shannon O’Shea, UNICEF Agenda 2030 Partnerships and Tatiana Landysheva, AIESEC discussed the partnerships that are globally bringing the messages of the SDGs to young people. The panel discussed the importance of educating, entertaining and engaging children and young people on the issues in the SDGs as well as recognizing young people as valuable change agents and partners in implementing the agenda.



JOIN UNICEF'S *CLIMATE! COMIC! CONTEST!*



We are pleased to share with you UNICEF's [*Climate! Comic! Contest!*](#) seeking to showcase the power of young people in protecting the planet. This contest invites anyone up to 25 years of age to create and submit a climate-saving superhero by October 22, for the chance to produce their very own comic book. The top superhero submissions will be voted on worldwide on the [campaign website](#) during the UN Climate Conference (COP23) in November to highlight the innovative ideas young people have in implementing the SDGs and the Paris Agreement. The winner will work with UNICEF and a professional team at [Comics Uniting Nations](#) to bring their

superhero to comic-book life and become an official book of the Comics UN Library, shared across the globe on Earth Day 2018! We invite UNICEF Country Offices and National Committees to join us in inspiring children and youth to take climate action through creativity! There are two specific ways in which we seek your support:

1. [Promote the contest to youth groups and on social media](#). This social media pack (EN, SP, FR, AR) provides assets for promoting the submission period (October 5- 22) the voting period (November 6- 17) and the final comic book launch on Earth Day 2018 (April 22).
2. [Lead a climate comic hero workshop](#). As part of the contest, UNICEF developed a [Workshop and Classroom Toolkit](#) (EN, SP, FR, AR) for educators and young leaders to bring the contest to the classroom, campus or community so as to help raise climate change awareness in a creative way. UNICEF offices can help facilitate workshops or connect with partners such as schools and youth organizations to do so themselves.



The [Comics Workshop Toolkit](#) walks participants through a climate change lesson plan and a creative superhero-building activity. Applications can be scanned and submitted either to engage@unicef.org or through the online application forms (EN, SP, FR, AR) available on the [campaign website](#).

For a full timeline of the campaign, see below:

- October 5 - 22: Digital superhero **submissions** form open and **workshops** organized around the world!
- November 6 -17: Global **vote** on top superheroes!
- End of November: **Winner** announced!
- Earth Day, April 22: Climate comic book **launch!**

See the campaign website for updates [here](#) and for any questions, email [Kristen Cordero](#) and [Callie Anne King-Guffey](#). Send photos of your workshop to be featured on social media!



MAPPING OF UN SYSTEM'S SDG FUNCTIONS AND CAPACITIES

One of the requests specifically made to the Secretary General in the QCPR was to undertake a mapping exercise of the UN's functions and capacities against the SDGs, with the aim of identifying gaps and overlaps, and to provide recommendations for addressing them. PPD provided UNICEF's inputs in close collaboration with colleagues from DFAM, DHR, DOC, DRP, Evaluation Office, FRG and PD.

[The findings and recommendations](#) of the SG's exercise undertaken by Dalberg Consultants were used as an input to the [SG's report](#) released in June. The data used in the exercise are rough estimates only, and can only be used indicatively. Overall findings of the exercise include:

- The UN system is portrayed as well-equipped against the social pillar SDGs, but needs more focus on the economic and environmental pillars.
- The UN system is well-equipped for humanitarian response, direct support/service delivery, etc. – but less well positioned in terms of normative support, integrated policy support, and data.
- Perceived gaps relevant to UNICEF include aspects of SDG 6 (water and sanitation), most particularly water resource management and water use efficiency; and UN-wide capacity for data literacy, technology, collection and analysis.

Issues and overlaps most relevant to UNICEF include the need for more cross-agency collaboration on social protection; and for harmonized data and reporting systems across agencies, to facilitate system-wide reporting, accountability and enhanced visibility of collective results.

For questions about the mapping exercise please contact [Madhavi Ashok](#) or [Christopher Stokes](#).

DATA FOR CHILDREN STRATEGY

Data emerged as a main theme in the 43 Voluntary National Reviews, presenting both challenges and opportunities for all countries to leave no one behind in achieving the SDGs. UNICEF acknowledges that the new global commitment to equity in the SDGs require new ways of identifying the most vulnerable children.

UNICEF's [Data for Children Strategic Framework](#) defines key principles for UNICEF's data work, informed by the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and UNICEF's Strategic Plan, both of which explicitly recognize the key role of data in achieving results. The framework is designed to provide a broad overview of how UNICEF thinks about data for children and to lay out initial steps – already underway in numerous countries – for reorienting our investments.

The framework addresses how UNICEF's long track record of data work has put the organization in a leadership position for assisting with several child-focused indicators in the SDG framework. This position comes with a responsibility to continue supporting countries in the measurement, collection, analysis and use of these data as well as global work to improve the quality, timeliness and relevance of SDG data. Some of the strategy's SDG-related shifts in programming, coordination and capacity include:

1. **Establish SDG baselines and monitoring.** The indicators for the SDGs are owned by and primarily the responsibility of countries. UNICEF will support governments in establishing baselines and monitoring the SDGs, including work to collect child-related data through a range of data tools, including household

surveys, administrative data sources, censuses and other sources of robust data. UNICEF will strengthen its own efforts to make sure that those data are used for decision-making at all levels.

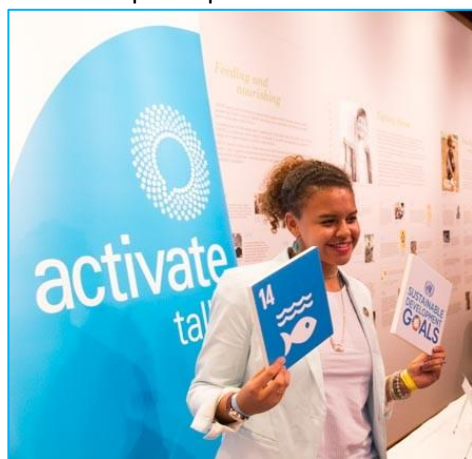
2. **Maintain global leadership responsibilities in the context of the SDGs.** UNICEF has been designated as the lead or co-lead of a large number of child-related SDG indicators. UNICEF will continue to work with others to develop methodologies for the indicators for which current data are either non-existent or of poor quality, while providing quality assurance and analytics in those areas where data are already widely available. UNICEF will continue to refine methods for current indicators and seek out the best opportunities to collect and use data in the most challenging contexts.
3. **Strengthen capacity to support countries on data for SDG monitoring and implementation.** As part of its commitment to support countries in collecting and using data for the SDGs, UNICEF will strengthen its efforts to innovate and accelerate results from household surveys. This will include MICS as well as other household survey tools.

The Data Strategy Team in DRP can be reached at dataforchildren@unicef.org. Please reach out to them if you're interested in the work and want to learn more!

UNICEF HOSTS ACTIVATE TALK WITH YOUTH LEADERS AND INNOVATORS DURING UN OCEANS CONFERENCE

On the margins of the UN Oceans Conference and on the eve of World Oceans Day, over 200 people gathered at UNICEF Headquarters to witness a group of seven young “wave makers” ranging from 10 to 24 years old discuss the role of children and youth in implementing the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), including SDG 14: Life Below Water. The Activate Talk was titled “[Young Change Makers go Under the Sea.](#)”

The discussion highlighted the different ways in which kids are already taking action on ocean conservation through inventing, campaigning and innovating. “UNICEF’s mandate is to advocate for every child’s right to learn about and participate in matters that affect their lives,” explained Olav Kjørven, UNICEF Director of Public



Partnerships. “The health of the oceans is critically linked to the healthy lives of children -- and indeed -- to all of us. Therefore, raising awareness on issues of environmental sustainability -- including the preservation of oceans -- is part of our responsibility in fulfilling and advocating for those rights.” The talk opened with a Keynote address from SDG Young Leader, Karan Jerath. Jerath captivated the room with his story of inventing a device during his High School Science Fair which can temporarily prevent the environmental devastation of oil spills, which happen every day. Jerath was then followed by a young, dynamic and diverse panel of young change makers. A reception and interactive fair thereafter invited the young audience to network with the young change makers and learn how to get involved in ocean

conservation, ranging from art competitions to beach clean-up campaigns.

Also featured at the Activate Talk was the launching and signing of a new [Comics Uniting Nations](#) project called [Annie Sunbeam and Friends](#), illustrated by renowned DC Comics Illustrator Bernard Chang and produced by

Debbie Margolis-Horwitz. The superhero, Annie, takes her friends on an underwater adventure to solve ocean pollution.

UNICEF is collaborating with young change makers from around the world on an SDG Activate Talk series with the two intentions of bringing the messages of the SDGs to the young public as well as showcasing to decision-makers the positive actions children and young people are already taking on various issues within the agenda. This was UNICEF's second SDG Activate Talk since the adoption of Agenda 2030 by Member States in September 2015.

"It was the voices of children and youth that inspired us to create the SDG Activate Talk series, which is both an acknowledgement and celebration of what young people are doing in their lives, their academic pursuits and their commitments to make our world a more safe, sustainable and equitable place and to help achieve the SDGs," said Shannon O'Shea, UNICEF Agenda 2030 Partnerships Manager. "If young people are not involved, the SDGs will be doomed to fail."



Activate Talks were designed to take place in any UNICEF office. For the methodology to host an Activate Talk in your country and community, please visit [here](#).

WORLD'S LARGEST LESSON IN CAMEROON INSPIRES CHILDREN AND THE COMMUNITY TO COMPOST

For the 2017 [World's Largest Lesson](#), the Government of Cameroon and UNICEF implemented a special project on food production. UNICEF Cameroon produced the [following video](#), inviting you on a journey to Africa's rainforest in Cameroon, where a teacher from Yaounde, the capital, has been sent to teach rural, Baka (Pygme) children how to sustainably increase food production by making compost. This has turned out to be a life-changing lesson for not only the students but their families, inspiring more sustainable farming practices in the rainforest community. As the video produced by UNICEF Cameroon quotes, "since the lesson took place, it was reported that more than half of the families in the village started using for the first time natural compost to fertilize their crops. When school children become agents of change, a simple lesson can change the life of a community."



Watch video produced by UNICEF Cameroon [here](#).

This work is an example of how the World's Largest Lesson can inspire action on the SDGs. The aim of teaching about the SDGs is to ultimately empower young people in leading community-wide transformations in behaviors and practices necessary for SDG success. It is a helpful reminder as to why UNICEF advocates for children's participation in SDG implementation and monitoring efforts with governments and partners.



THE WORLD'S LARGEST LESSON 3.0

The [World's Largest Lesson](#) is a global initiative delivered in partnership with UNICEF, to raise children and young people's awareness of the Sustainable Development Goals and to encourage their active participation in making the Goals a reality by 2030. Since it was launched in 2015, the World's Largest Lesson has reached millions of children, in 106 countries, in over 40 languages. This is thanks to huge support from across sectors, including 58 ministries of education. The 2017 suite of materials, focusing on this year's theme '**Healthy not Hungry**' launched on 18 September 2017. By encouraging the educators and students of your country to take part in the World's Largest Lesson you can:

1. **Teach** many more children and young people about Sustainable Development and the Goals (or remind those that took part last year) and **inspire** them to contribute to the achievement of the Goals by 2030.
2. Make the Goals **local and personal** by inviting students to take part in our 2017 project "Every Plate Tells a Story", where they will investigate how their own meal is linked to the Global Goals and discover how the food they eat can play a part in the Global Goals success.

For any questions about the World's Largest Lesson contact [Shannon O'Shea](#) or [Sonia Yeo](#).



See the new 'Healthy not Hungry' suite of materials [here](#)

READ THIS

- AIESEC's [Young Person's Guide to Saving the World](#)

WATCH THIS

- This [video](#) showcases the first youth-led World's Largest Lesson activation taking place in Cartagena, Colombia as part of AIESEC YouthSpeak Forum. Nearly 600 youth delegates taught the World's Largest Lesson to 5000 students, in partnership with UNICEF.
- Watch [this video](#) and [highlight reel](#), both produced after the High Level Political Forum Side Event that hosted 80 students for a discussion on how to use the World's Largest Lesson to raise the awareness and inspire the participation of children and youth in the SDGs.
- See the SDG version of the YouTube viral video sensation "Pen Pineapple Apple Pen (PPAP)" [here](#). The Government of Japan commissioned YouTube star Pikotaro to do an SDG version of PPAP as a means to get the public aware of the SDGs. Pico Taro also visited UNHQ to share the video during the 2017 HLPF.

TRY THIS (TOOLS AND PLATFORMS)

- [Data for Children](#): Guided by the SDGs and Strategic Plan, this site serves as a central library of UNICEF's data expertise and an engine connect you to the right people, resources and answers to help you do your work. By making information open and accessible, we can build upon our previous discoveries and accelerate progress.



- [Localizing the SDGs](#): Are you working on the SDGs within a sub-national context? Would you like to learn more about the role of local governments in achieving the SDGs? Or, do you have relevant materials on 'localizing the SDGs' that you would like to share? Check out the localizing the SDGs website for resources.
- [Teaching the SDGs](#): Microsoft partnered with the World's Largest Lesson to launch a comprehensive online training course to prepare educators on teaching the Sustainable Development Goals using the World's Largest Lesson in the classroom.

STANDARD BRIEFING AND SUPPORTING MATERIALS

- [Mainstreaming the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development: Reference Guide to UN Country Teams](#) (updated in March 2017)
- [Key Asks and Principles for National Review Activities for UNICEF Country Offices and National Committees \(Version 2.0\)](#)
- [#EVERYCHILD 2030: UNICEF Standard Briefing Note on the Agenda 2030 for Sustainable Development](#)
- [#EVERYCHILD 2030: The Sustainable Development Goals and What they mean for UNICEF and for Children: Standard PowerPoint Presentation](#)

ABOUT THE NEWSLETTER

This newsletter should be seen as a companion to the [#EVERYCHILD 2030](#) SharePoint Site and [SDG Yammer Community](#) which we would highly encourage you to join. The news updates will highlight key information, dates and deadlines. The updates will be sent out via Global Message Broadcast and posted to ICON. Please keep us informed of activities your office and the UN Country Team are planning with regard to SDG Implementation by posting to the [Yammer Group](#) or emailing [Callie King-Guffey](#) or [Shannon O'Shea](#).

THE 17 GLOBAL GOALS FOR SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

([download group and individual icons here](#))

